

shocked to learn how wealthy they are. They don't fit the mold of what society tells us millionaires look like.

A Race You Can Win

If you believe you could never become a millionaire, then you will always prove yourself right. You'll never save enough or work hard enough to overcome that core conviction. However, if you open yourself up to the possibility—the *probability*—that a \$1 million net worth is within your reach, then you'll already be halfway to the goal. Your success will follow your beliefs; it's up to you to decide where you want to go. You have to believe that you have what it takes—because you do.

Of course, if you set your goals toward millionaire status, there will be plenty of people who will try to convince you it can't be done. They'll explain all the reasons why someone like you can't become a millionaire. I've got a trick for dealing with people like that. It's a secret that I use to make them disappear. It's easy to remember too. In fact, it's just three little words: *prove them wrong*. When the world tells you that you can't do it, don't believe it for a second. Just put all your effort and work into proving them wrong.

A great example of this is the late Roger Bannister, the first man in history to run a mile in under four minutes. Up to then, many people widely believed that such a feat was impossible, that human beings simply could not run that fast. Some even believed someone's heart could explode from the effort! Roger Bannister didn't listen. He chose to follow his own beliefs and reject the other voices. Then, on May 6, 1954, Bannister made history by completing the mile in 3:59.4 minutes. And guess what? It didn't kill him. His belief that he *could* do it enabled him to overcome the naysayers and "experts" who said it couldn't be done. That's not all, though. Six weeks later, someone else broke Bannister's record. No one had ever broken the four-minute mile before, but now two different people had done it within weeks of each other. Today, more than sixty years later, the one-mile record has dropped all the way down to 3:43. All it took was one man saying, "I can do this. I *will* do this." Once he proved it was possible, others embraced the possibility for themselves and made it happen.